

Route 1

Estudios Superiores

The only student permit worth having, every Spanish university that can grant it, and what each one costs — the language year, the master's, and the city you would live in.

THE ARTICLE	Art. 52.1.a) RD 1155/2024 — <i>estudios superiores</i>
WHAT IT GRANTS	30 h/week work automatically · full course duration · two extensions · Art. 190 conversion
UNIVERSITIES COVERED	35 language centres · 16 comunidades autónomas
TARGET START	January 2027
BUDGET	€8,000, covering tuition, means proof, insurance, flights and living costs

Why only Route 1 matters

Spanish law offers two student permits for a language course. They are not two versions of the same thing.

THE SAME VISA APPLICATION, TWO DIFFERENT PERMITS

	ROUTE 1 — ART. 52.1.A)	ROUTE 2 — ART. 52.1.E).2º
How you qualify	In-person course at a university	Course at an EOI or an Instituto Cervantes -accredited school — nowhere else
Work	30 h/week automatically , nothing to apply for	A separate application must be filed
Duration granted	The full official length of the course	Capped at one year
Extensions	Two	One , and only on passing DELE, SIELE or an EOI exam
Family	May bring them	May not
Convert to a work permit	Yes — Art. 190	Excluded

"Autoriza automáticamente y sin necesidad de un trámite adicional al ejercicio de una actividad laboral..."

"It authorises, automatically and with no need for any additional procedure, the exercise of employment..."

ART. 57.1, FOURTH PARAGRAPH — THIS SENTENCE APPLIES ONLY TO ROUTE 1

ARTICLE 190 IS THE WALL

Every other difference is inconvenience. This one ends the plan. Art. 190 is how a student authorisation becomes a **work permit** after your master's — no labour-market test, employer pays the fee, and from the moment the file is admitted you move to **provisional residence with full-time work rights** (Art. 190.7).

Art. 190.1 expressly excludes 52.1.e).2º. On Route 2 you finish the master's and then you leave. Your plan is Spanish → master's → work in Spain; Route 2 delivers the first two and stops.

What Art. 190 actually gives you

- **No minimum study period.** The old three-year rule died with RD 557/2011. You need the qualification, not the years.
- **No labour-market test** (Art. 190.2 applies Art. 74 minus 1.a) — the employer does not have to prove no Spaniard wanted the job.
- **The employer pays the fee.**
- **Filing window:** two months before, or three months after, your permit expires **or** you obtain the qualification (Art. 190.6, as amended by RD 316/2026).
- **Full-time work from admission to *trámite*** — you do not wait for the decision (Art. 190.7).
- Granted for **one year**, renewable (Art. 190.9).

AND YOU NEVER HAVE TO LEAVE SPAIN

Art. 54.1, second paragraph, lets anyone "*regularmente en territorio nacional*" and over 18 file a new 52.1.a) application **from inside Spain**, at least two months before their current status expires. So: language year → master's application filed in Cáceres, not Tunis → master's → Art. 190 work permit. One continuous stay.

How you will know which one you got

Your TIE card carries the answer. A card issued under Route 2 prints "**NO AUTORIZA A TRABAJAR**". If you see that line, you are on the weak permit — and Art. 54.1§2 above lets you correct it from inside Spain rather than flying home.

What puts a course on Route 1

Three conditions, one definition, and two filters that people will try to sell you which do not exist.

The three conditions

*"Conforme al artículo 52.1.a) del RLOEX, se considerarán como estudios superiores los estudios idiomáticos impartidos **de forma presencial** por las **instituciones y centros de educación superior reconocidos**."*

"Under Article 52.1.a) of the RLOEX, language studies taught **face-to-face** by **recognised higher-education institutions** shall be considered higher studies."

INSTRUCCIÓN SEM 3/2025, PRIMERA.1 · PILAR CANCELA RODRÍGUEZ · 20 JUNE 2025

*"La lengua o lenguas en las que el solicitante se haya matriculado deberán ser **diferentes a la lengua materna** de la persona extranjera **o la lengua oficial del país** del que sea nacional."*

"The language or languages the applicant has enrolled in must be different from the foreign national's mother tongue or the official language of their country of nationality."

INSTRUCCIÓN SEM 3/2025, PRIMERA.2

1. **Presencial.** Face-to-face. Not online, not hybrid. This alone eliminates Las Palmas and every Universidad Europea Spanish course.
2. **A recognised higher-education institution.** Defined below.
3. **Not your own language.** Tunisia's official language is Arabic and your mother tongue is not Spanish. **You pass.** This clause quietly closes Route 1 to almost every Latin American applicant.

What "recognised higher-education institution" means

This is defined in the regulation itself, at Art. 52.1.a), sixth paragraph. Three alternatives, any one of which suffices:

- ☐ Accredited as a higher-education institution, **or**
- ☐ **Adscrito** to a recognised centre, **or**
- ☐ Inscribed in the Registro de Instituciones y Centros de Enseñanza Superior

THAT THIRD REGISTER DOES NOT EXIST YET

It has not been created. The Criterios de Gestión address the gap directly, and in doing so dispose of a claim you will see repeated on immigration blogs — that a centre must appear in the **RUCT**:

*"En tanto se crea el Registro de Instituciones y Centros de Enseñanza Superior, el establecimiento que imparta las clases debe contar con un **convenio vigente de colaboración**; no es necesario que esté **adscrito** ni **figure** en el RUCT."*

"Until the Register of Higher Education Institutions and Centres is created, the establishment teaching the classes must have a collaboration agreement in force; it need not be attached to, nor appear in, the RUCT."

CRITERIOS DE GESTIÓN §9 · 23 JUNE 2025

I searched the RUCT directly. **No university language centre of any kind appears in it** — not Cáceres, not Zaragoza, not Granada. Registration of the **institution** is what counts; the internal unit needs no entry of its own.

Two filters that do not exist

"En los estudios de idiomas, habrá de estarse a lo que determine el plan de estudios. La carga horaria semanal puede ser de pocas horas."

"In language studies, whatever the study plan determines applies. The weekly hours may be few."

CRITERIOS DE GESTIÓN §4 — THERE IS NO 20-HOUR MINIMUM FOR A LANGUAGE COURSE

"En el caso de las enseñanzas superiores, existen los títulos oficiales y los títulos propios. Ambos son admisibles para la obtención de una autorización de estancia por estudios."

"In higher education there are official qualifications and universities' own qualifications. Both are admissible for obtaining a student authorisation."

CRITERIOS DE GESTIÓN §8 — NO OFFICIAL DEGREE IS REQUIRED

The three shapes a Route 1 centre takes

SHAPE	WHAT IT MEANS	WHAT YOU MUST ASK FOR
A — the university's own department or service	Fees are <i>precios públicos</i> approved by the university's own governing body. The cleanest position.	Nothing extra.
B — a foundation linked to the university	<i>Fundación general</i> or <i>fundación universidad-empresa</i> handles the money and often the teaching.	The <i>convenio</i> , plus the university's certification.
C — a company the university owns	An S.A., S.L. or S.A.U. with the university as sole or majority shareholder.	The <i>convenio</i> , the certification, the study-plan summary and the control system — all four, per §9.

All three stay on Route 1. B and C simply carry a documentary burden that A does not. Ask them this, in writing, before you pay:

*¿Existe un **convenio vigente de colaboración** — o, en su caso, un **encargo a medio propio** — con la Universidad para la impartición de este curso, y puede la Universidad expedir una certificación en la que conste que los estudios están conveniados en el curso académico correspondiente, junto con un resumen del plan de estudios?*

"Is there a collaboration agreement in force — or, as the case may be, an in-house-provider assignment — with the University for delivering this course, and can the University issue a certification stating that the studies are covered for the relevant academic year, together with a summary of the study plan?"

ASK FOR BOTH. CHAPTER 3 EXPLAINS WHY THE SECOND IS WHAT ACTUALLY EXISTS

A WRINKLE YOU SHOULD KNOW BEFORE YOU ASK

Criterios §9 names a *convenio de colaboración*. **No Spanish university language centre has one.** What they have is an **encargo a medio propio** under Ley 9/2017 — a different instrument, published in the university's own bulletin. Chapter 3 sets out the evidence. It is arguably stronger than a *convenio*, but it is not what the Criterios asks for by name, so raise it yourself rather than letting an officer find the mismatch.

Two thresholds to design around

91 DAYS, AND SIX MONTHS

91 calendar days is the minimum course length (Criterios §3). Below it there is no authorisation at all.

Six months is the line that matters more. Above it — "*superior a seis meses*", so 181 to 184 days depending on the dates — you receive a **TIE** and a real residence. Below it, a visa sticker and a flight home.

Art. 55.2 allows the authorisation to run one month before the course and fifteen days after. But Instrucción TERCERA.1 makes that padding **optional and waivable in writing**. Never design a plan that needs it to cross six months.

AND LENGTH IS A LEVER, NOT A CONSTRAINT

Art. 55.1 grants a Route 1 authorisation **the full official duration of the studies** — no one-year cap, unlike every other category. Criterios §4 allows that duration to be assembled from semesters or trimesters. And Criterios §6 asks for financial means **for the first year only**, so a longer course does not mean a larger frozen account.

The practical move: get **one enrolment certificate** covering the whole block, showing start date, end date, total hours and weekly hours. Not three receipts for three terms.

The Route 1 register

Every Spanish university language centre, by region. All of these are on Route 1 — they differ in price, calendar and how much paperwork the legal form costs you.

READING THE TABLE

Shape is A, B or C from Chapter 2 — the university's own service, a linked foundation, or a company it owns. **91d?** says whether any published course reaches the 91-day minimum. **Jan** is a January 2027 start date where one is published. Every price was read from the centre's own page. A flag marks a page carrying a stale academic year. **"not publ."** means the figure genuinely is not published — a finding, not a gap.

Extremadura, Castilla y León, Castilla–La Mancha

CENTRE · CITY	BEST PRICE	HOURS	JAN 2027	91D?	SHAPE
IELE · Cáceres	2.500 / 11 months	20 h/wk	18 Jan → 18 Dec	✓	B
Centro de Idiomas · León	3.600 / 720h, 60 ECTS	20 h/wk	7 Jan → 21 Dec	✓	B
Centro Intl. del Español · Burgos	3.000 / 620h	not publ.	— (annual starts Aug)	✓	A
Centro de Idiomas · Valladolid 25-26	3.570 / 425h	15–16 h/wk	"Jan–mid-May", no date	✓	B
ESTO · Toledo 23-24	5.845 → 7.355 / 900h	20 h/wk	—	✓	B
Cursos Internacionales · Salamanca	1.720 / 10 wks	15 h/wk	11 Jan (68 days)	✗ none	C

Aragón, La Rioja, Navarra, País Vasco, Cantabria, Asturias

CENTRE · CITY	BEST PRICE	HOURS	JAN 2027	91D?	SHAPE
CELE · Zaragoza	2.230 / 770h · Jan block 1.360	20 h/wk	11 Jan → 19 May	✓	A
Cursos de Español · La Rioja	3.880 / 585h · Jan sem. 2.725	20 h/wk	11 Jan → 16 Jun	✓	B
Casa de las Lenguas · Oviedo	2.494 · Jan sem. 1.625	not publ.	11 Jan → 14 May	✓	A
ILCE · Pamplona	7.080 (60 ECTS × 118)	~20 h/wk	"Enero–Mayo", no date	✓	A
CIUC · Santander	332 / 60h	5 h/wk	11 Jan (40h intensive)	✓ (94d)	A
Centro Superior de Idiomas · Pamplona	599 / semester	1.5–2 h/wk	1 Feb	✓	A
UIMP · Santander	710 / 4 wks	25 h/wk	— summer only	✗ none	A
Cursos de Español y Euskara · UPV/EHU	180	4 h/wk	25 Jan	✓	closed to outsiders

Galicia

CENTRE · CITY	BEST PRICE	HOURS	JAN 2027	91D?	SHAPE
Cursos Internacionales · Santiago	2.691 + 230 / 21 wks	20 h/wk	7 Jan — beginners only 7 Jan	✓	C
Centro de Lenguas · A Coruña	180 / 30h	3 h/wk	—	✗ (78d)	B
Centro de Lenguas · Vigo	570 / 120h	4 h/wk	not publ.	✓ (86d, marginal)	B

Madrid

CENTRE · CITY	BEST PRICE	HOURS	JAN 2027	91D?	SHAPE
CCEE Complutense	5.550 / 600h inmersión	25 h/wk	8 Jan → 28 Jul	✓	A
Alcalingua · Alcalá	5.310 / 600h	16–17 h/wk	7 Jan (quarterlies all <91d)	✓ annual only	C
Centro de Idiomas · UC3M	4.000 / 600h	20 h/wk	— Oct only, window closed	✓	B
Centro de Estudios Hispánicos · Nebrija	4.510 / Jan+spring	15–20 h/wk	8 Jan → 20 May	✓	C
Servicio de Idiomas · UAM	250 / yr	3 h/wk (70 contact h)	—	✓	A
Centro de Lenguas · UPM	not publ.	4 h/wk	—	✓ (95d)	A
IUNIT ADSCRITO URJC · RUCT 28054816	not publ.	15 h/wk	none published	?	C

Andalucía

CENTRE · CITY	BEST PRICE	HOURS	JAN 2027	91D?	SHAPE
CIE · Málaga COAST	800 / month	20 h/wk	8–29 Jan , monthly	stack months	B
Centro de Lenguas · Almería COAST	2.700 / 600h VERIFY	20 h/wk	— Feb intake unpublished	✓	B
CLM · Granada	4.199 / 450h · 6.058 / 520h Jan–Jul	20 h/wk	8 Jan	✓	C
UCOIdiomas · Córdoba	5.088 / 600h	not publ.	— (15 Feb)	✓	C
CUI · Pablo de Olavide, Sevilla	2.655 / semester	not publ.	25 Jan	✓	A/B unclear
CSLM · Cádiz COAST	534 / 180h	~18 h/wk	8 Jan (3 wks)	X (72d)	B
Instituto de Idiomas · Sevilla	425 / 90h	3 h/wk	— (17 Feb)	✓ (114d)	A
SLM · Huelva 2024 COAST	190 / 45h	~3 h/wk	—	✓ (96d)	A
CEALM · Jaén STALE	300 / 60h	4 h/wk	"a determinar"	✓ (109d)	A
Centro Internacional · Sevilla	not publ. 17/18	4 h/day	—	✓	A

Levante, Murcia, Cataluña, Baleares

CENTRE · CITY	BEST PRICE	HOURS	JAN 2027	91D?	SHAPE
CSIdiomas · Alicante COAST	4.500 / 32 wks · 6.665 Jan→Dec	15–25 h/wk	7 Jan → 17 Dec	✓	C
Servicio de Idiomas · Murcia	1.575 / 300h, 10 ECTS	~18 h/wk	— (Feb–May)	✓	A
Estudios Hispánicos · UB Barcelona	6.444 / 580h "para visado"	20 h/wk	18 Jan → 22 Apr (1.714)	✓	A
Idiomes UAB · Barcelona	236 / week from 13 wks	20 h/wk	monthly starts	✓ at 13 wks	C
Idiomes UPF · Barcelona	640h course via China agency	20 h/wk	25 Jan (51d)	✗ open courses	B
Centre d'Idiomes · València COAST	408 / 60h	4 h/wk	— winter sem. ends 25 Jan	✓ (127d)	B
Centro de Lenguas UPV · València 25-26	450 / 48h	4 h/wk	—	✓ (98d)	A
Institut de Llengües · Lleida	208–292 / 50–70h	4–6 h/wk	—	✓ (105d)	A
CEH · Tarragona COAST	not publ. / 600h+120h	4 h/wk	not publ.	✓	B
Servicio de Idiomas · Cartagena COAST	125 / semester	2.5 h/wk	— (18 Feb)	✓ (101d)	A
SLT · Castelló COAST	262 / 70h	10.5 h/wk	— (Feb)	✗ none	A
Centro Intl. de Estudios de Español · UIB COAST	425 / 60h	7.5 h/wk	— (1 Feb)	✗ (75d)	B
Instituto de Lenguas · UCV Valencia	525 / 75h	4 h/wk	—	✓ (91d exactly)	A

Canarias

CENTRE · CITY	BEST PRICE	HOURS	JAN 2027	91D?	SHAPE
Servicio de Idiomas · La Laguna COAST	250 / 50h	3 h/wk	not publ.	✓ (105d)	B
Aula de Idiomas · Las Palmas	275 / online	0 — asynchronous	—	✓	fails presencial

THREE THAT ARE ON ROUTE 1 IN PRINCIPLE AND UNAVAILABLE IN PRACTICE

Salamanca — no course reaches 91 days. The year-long *Diploma de Estudios Hispánicos* returns "Invalid course id" and is gone from the sitemap.

UPV/EHU — "Estos cursos no están abiertos a estudiantado ajeno a la EHU."

Las Palmas — Spanish is offered online only, asynchronous, zero contact hours. Condition 1 of Chapter 2 fails outright.

TWO UNIVERSITIES TEACH NO SPANISH AT ALL

Universitat de Girona's Servei de Llengües Modernes covers German, English, French and Catalan. **Universitat Ramon Llull's** Serveis Lingüístics exist for Catalan. Neither has a Spanish-for-foreigners programme, despite what aggregator sites list.

Who legally delivers each course

All thirty-five centres were checked against their own *aviso legal*, their payment details and their award wording. Two findings change how you should ask your questions.

FINDING ONE: THE *CONVENIO CRITERIOS* §9 ASKS FOR DOES NOT EXIST

Not at a single centre in Spain. What universities actually use is an *encargo a medio propio* — the in-house-provider device under Ley 9/2017 — not a *convenio de colaboración* between arm's-length parties.

"Encargo de la Universidad de Granada a FORMACIÓN Y GESTIÓN DE GRANADA, S.L.M.P., en su condición de Medio Propio, para la prestación del servicio de apoyo a la gestión del Centro de Lenguas Modernas (CLM)"

"Assignment by the University of Granada to Formación y Gestión de Granada S.L.M.P., in its capacity as an in-house provider, for the provision of management-support services to the Modern Languages Centre."

UGR GERENCIA, 5 MAY 2025 · BOUGR Nº 276

The same device recurs everywhere: **UCOIDIOMAS S.L. M.P.** · FGULEM, which *"actúa como medio propio de la Universidad de León"* · Fundación General de La Rioja **M.P.** So when you ask for the *convenio*, expect an *encargo*. That is arguably **stronger** — it is the university's own published act of assignment, in its official bulletin — but it is not the document the *Criterios* names. Say so before an officer has to ask.

FINDING TWO: THE *TÍTULO PROPIO* QUESTION IS CLOSED

Not one of the thirty-five describes its Spanish course as a *título propio expedido por la universidad*. The only "título propio" found anywhere was Granada's **Máster** — a different product. The strongest university-branded wording in Spain is Burgos's *"Diploma de la Universidad de Burgos"*.

If Route 1 required a *título propio*, **no university language course in Spain would qualify**. That cannot be what an instruction aimed at *"fomentar su internacionalización"* was meant to achieve. The reading in Chapter 2 stands.

CENTRE	SHAPE	ENTITY AND CIF	WHAT IT AWARDS	ECTS
IELE Extremadura	A + B	Site and award: Univ. de Extremadura Q0618001B . Money: Fundación Universidad-Sociedad G06456487	"Certificate from the University of Extremadura"	–
CELE Zaragoza	A	Universidad de Zaragoza — <i>precios públicos</i>	not stated	2,5–3,5
CLM Granada	C	Formación y Gestión de Granada SLMP B-18432583	Certificado de calificaciones	–
CIE Málaga	B	Fundación General UMA G29817301	"reconocidos por la Universidad de Málaga" via ECTS	yes
UCOIdiomas Córdoba	C	UCOIDIOMAS S.L. M.P. B14534739	Informe de aprovechamiento	–
Centro de Idiomas León	B	FGULEM — <i>medio propio</i> of ULE	Certificado acreditativo	60/yr
Centro Intl. Burgos	B / A award	Fundación General UBU G09343500	"Diploma de la Universidad de Burgos"	6
Centro de Idiomas Valladolid	B	Fundación Universidad de Valladolid G47382056	Completion certificate per sublevel	8
CCEE Complutense	B	Fundación General UCM	Diploma-Certificado; certificates €15 each	yes
Alcalingua Alcalá	C	Alcalingua-UAH S.R.L. B82335902	not stated	–
Centro de Idiomas UC3M	B	Fundación Univ. Carlos III G79852257	Diploma with duration, level and grade	2–4
Servicio de Idiomas UAM	A	Universidad Autónoma de Madrid	SIELE / CELE C1 routes	yes
Centro de Lenguas UPM	A	Universidad Politécnica de Madrid	not stated	3–8
ESTO Toledo	B	Fundación General UCLM G-13289806	"certificado oficial de la UCLM"	–
Casa de las Lenguas Oviedo	A	Universidad de Oviedo Q3318001I	"Certificado de Aprovechamiento expedido por la Universidad de Oviedo"	–
CIUC Cantabria	A	Universidad de Cantabria	not stated	–
Cursos de Español La Rioja	B	Fundación de la Univ. de La Rioja M.P.	Diploma used as a <i>transcript</i>	none
Cursos Intl. USC Santiago	C	Cursos Internacionais da USC S.L. B15544554	certificates page 404s	–
Centro de Lenguas UDC	A	Universidade da Coruña	Acreditación, 85% attendance	yes

Centro de Linguas Vigo	B	Fundación Universidade de Vigo G36.826.030	Certificado de nivel, ES and EN	–
Centro de Linguas Almería	A	Universidad de Almería	Diplomas de español	4
CSLM Cádiz	A / B money	UCA unit; FUECA G11442167 is "entidad gestora"	diplomas page 404s	1,5–3
Instituto de Idiomas Sevilla	A	Universidad de Sevilla	Certificado por competencias; CertACLES	3
SLM Huelva	A	Univ. de Huelva — fees approved by its Consejo Social	Certificate with final grades	8
CEALM Jaén	A	Universidad de Jaén	only external credentials named	–
CUI Pablo de Olavide	A / B	UPO Q9150016E; also Fundación UPO G91094235	Certificado ECTS	6
Centre d'Idiomes UV	B	Fundació General UV G46980207 — the former S.L. was dissolved into it in 2024	Certificate with hours, nature, level, performance	–
Centro de Linguas UPV	A	Universitat Politècnica de València	"Certificación: Asistencia"	4,5
CSIdiomas Alicante	C	CSIdiomas UA S.A.U. A-53013355 — UA is sole shareholder	Diploma/Certificado de Asistencia	6 / 60h
SLT Jaume I	A	Universitat Jaume I	Certificats amb crèdits ECTS	yes
Servicio de Idiomas Murcia	A	Universidad de Murcia	"diploma del Servicio de Idiomas de la Universidad de Murcia"	1–3
Servicio de Idiomas UPCT	A	Univ. Politécnica de Cartagena	not stated	2
Estudios Hispánicos UB	A	Universitat de Barcelona	"certificado oficial... el número de horas de estudio a la semana... para tramitar el visado"	12 / 90h
Idiomes UAB	C	Escola d'Idiomes Casa Convalescència S.L.U.	Certificado de curso	–
Institut de Llengües UdL	A	Universitat de Lleida	Certificats propis de la UdL	3,5–5

THE WORDING TO COPY – FROM BARCELONA

UB is the **only centre in Spain** that states what its certificate contains, and it is exactly what a consulate needs:

*"te enviaremos un **certificado oficial** en el que consta el **número de horas de estudio a la semana** y los programas que se seguirán para que puedas **tramitar el visado**."*

"we will send you an official certificate stating the number of study hours per week and the programmes to be followed, so that you can process your visa."

[EH.UB.EDU/ES/INFORMACION/VISADOS/](https://eh.ub.edu/es/informacion/visados/) – QUOTE THIS BACK TO CÁCERES WHEN YOU ASK FOR THE SAME

NOBODY HAS HEARD OF THE INSTRUCTION

Domain-restricted searches were run across all thirty-five university sites for "RD 1155/2024", "Art. 52.1.a)", "estudios superiores" and "Instrucción SEM". **Zero hits on any language-centre page.** Even UB's dedicated visa page — scraped in full — contains none of them; it argues purely on hours and then says "*consulta con el Consulado de España en tu país el número de horas semanales de estudio.*"

You will be raising Instrucción SEM 3/2025 with people who do not know it exists. Attach it.

ONE NEGATIVE WORTH PRICING IN

La Rioja awards no credits of its own. Its diploma is explicitly a *transcript* for you to convert into credits at your home university — which, as a Tunisian graduate not enrolled anywhere else, you do not have. Every other centre on the shortlist grants ECTS directly.

The January 2027 shortlist

Of thirty-five Route 1 centres, these are the ones with a published January start that lasts long enough to matter.

Ranked by what you get for the money

	CENTRE	PRICE	PERIOD	DAYS	+45	TIE
1	IELE Cáceres	2.500	18 Jan → 18 Dec 2027	335	380	✓
2	León — 3 trimestres	3.600	7 Jan → 21 Dec 2027	344	389	✓
3	La Rioja — semestral	2.725	11 Jan → 16 Jun 2027	157	202	if padded
4	León — 2 trimestres	2.600	7 Jan → 4 Jun 2027	149	194	if padded
5	Santiago — 21 weeks	2.691 +230	7 Jan → ~early Jun	147	192	if padded
6	Alicante — 44 weeks	6.200	7 Jan → 26 Nov 2027	308	353	✓
7	Alicante — full year	6.665	7 Jan → 17 Dec 2027	329	374	✓
8	Complutense — inmersión	5.550	8 Jan → 28 Jul 2027	202	247	✓
9	Granada — 520h	6.058	8 Jan → 29 Jul 2027	202	247	✓
10	Nebrija — Jan + spring	4.510	8 Jan → 20 May 2027	133	178	✗
11	Zaragoza — 4-month block	1.360	11 Jan → 19 May 2027	129	174	✗
12	Oviedo — semestral	1.625	11 Jan → 14 May 2027	124	169	✗
13	UB Barcelona — cuatrimestral	1.714	18 Jan → 22 Apr 2027	94	139	✗

Rows 10 to 13 end before six months. They are legal — all clear the 91-day floor — but they give you a visa sticker, not a TIE, and you fly home in spring. They belong on this list only because the price is tempting; the calendar is not.

The three that sell eleven months as one enrolment

Tested against the centres' own booking engines, not their brochures.

CENTRE	PRICE	HOW IT BOOKS
IELE Cáceres	2.500	One checkout ticket, or two payments of €1,250
León	3.600	Three trimester checkboxes on a single form ; the form even carries a field " <i>Necesita certificado para visado: Sí / No</i> "
Alicante	6.665	One start-date and one end-date field; the engine accepts 2028 end dates too

LEÓN'S FOUR-MONTH HOLE

León's three trimesters leave **5 June to 5 October 2027** with no classes inside your enrolment. Cáceres also has a break — 30 June to 9 September — but that is ten weeks inside a normal academic year. Four months is a different proposition, and a consulate may read it differently.

Cannot be extended: La Rioja's form is single-select and lists only 2026-27. Complutense's block is fixed. Santiago caps at 21 weeks. Nebrija sells January, spring, June and July as four separate products with no combined price.

Refund clauses — read before paying

CENTRE	IF TUNIS REFUSES THE VISA
IELE Cáceres	Refund minus €150 ; claim within 7 days, paid within 60. And a delayed visa lets you move to a later intake free: <i>"you may postpone the start of your course to a later edition without any inconvenience."</i>
La Rioja	Refund minus €150
Alicante	Refund minus €150 — but 100% of the fee must be paid up front to get the registration certificate, and you must cancel 72 hours before the start
León	Refund minus €500 once the invitation letter is issued
Complutense	Refund on production of the consulate's refusal letter; the €15 certificate fee is never refunded
Granada	Nothing. <i>"La denegación de visado no se considera causa justificada para la devolución del importe abonado."</i>

THIS REMOVES GRANADA FROM THE LIST

Granada would take €6,058 up front and return none of it if the visa is refused. No other Route 1 centre in Spain has that clause. Whatever else recommends the CLM, that single sentence makes it the wrong place to send your father's money.

What each will give you for the visa file

CENTRE	DOCUMENT	CONDITION
IELE Cáceres	Letter of Admission and Offer Letter	Email seciele@unex.es with name, nationality, passport number, course, start and end dates, passport copy, proof of payment
León	Carta de Invitación	On payment of the deposit. Issued at least three months before the course starts
Alicante	Registration certificate	100% of the fee + signed visa terms annex + passport copy
Complutense	Certificado provisional de matrícula	€15 fee, paid separately and never deducted from tuition
Granada	Certificado de matrícula	One week to issue. Two certificates maximum per course

A GAP WORTH KNOWING ABOUT

Not one of these centres states what its enrolment certificate actually contains. Only Granada describes any certificate's contents, and only for the grades document. Since the consulate reads that certificate to decide how long to grant you, ask explicitly that it show **start date, end date, total hours and weekly hours**. Do not assume.

The master's — and the region that decides its price

Spanish master's fees are set per credit by each region. Five of ten charge non-EU students more. The spread across your options is nine to one.

The surcharge map

REGION	NON-EU RULE	SOURCE
Andalucía — Granada, Málaga, Córdoba, Almería	No surcharge	Decreto 98/2023, mod. Decreto 142/2025
Castilla y León — León, Burgos, Valladolid	No surcharge	Decreto 8/2024, BOCyL
Extremadura	No surcharge	DOE 15/07/2024 — no differential article
Asturias — Oviedo	Permissive; no evidence applied	Decreto 2026-27, art. 1.2 — <i>"podrá diferenciar el precio"</i>
Murcia — UMU, UPCT	+20%	<i>"incrementados en un 20%"</i>
La Rioja	~+95% — a parallel fee table	24,61 → 47,94 €/ECTS
Alicante	×2	Decreto 101/2024 art. 6: <i>"se les aplicará el doble de los precios públicos"</i>
Zaragoza	×2 to ×3	The only university publishing an explicit EU / non-EU column
Madrid — Complutense	~×1.87 — pays the 3rd-enrolment rate	Decreto 43/2022 art. 8
Galicia — Santiago	NOT PUBLISHED delegated to a rectoral resolution	DECRETO 72/2026 art. 2.5

Computing master's, cheapest first

UNIVERSITY	PROGRAMME	NON-EU TOTAL	LANGUAGE	ECTS
Málaga	Ingeniería del Software e Inteligencia Artificial — 30 places	820,80	ES + EN	60
Granada	Ciencia de Datos e Ingeniería de Computadores	820,80	ES	60
Granada	Ciberseguridad y Ciberinteligencia · Ing. Informática	13,68 /ECTS	ES	—
Córdoba	Inteligencia Computacional e Internet de las Cosas — 25 places	820,80	ES	60
Almería	Ingeniería Informática · Informática Avanzada e Industrial	13,68 /ECTS	ES	—
León	Ingeniería Informática · Ciberseguridad · Robótica e IA · Big Data	1.572,00	ES	60
Burgos	Ingeniería Informática · Big Data en Entornos Seguros	1.572,00	ES	60
Valladolid	Ingeniería Informática · Big Data en Entornos Seguros	1.572,00	ES	60
Oviedo	Ingeniería Informática	1.910,70	ES	90
Murcia	Ciberseguridad — 25 places, online síncrono	3.045,00	EN	60
Murcia	Ingeniería del Software · IA · Big Data	3.045,00	ES	60
Alicante	Ingeniería Informática — 20 places	3.121,20	ES	90
Extremadura	Ingeniería Informática — EPCC Cáceres	3.366,90	ES	90
Zaragoza	Inteligencia Artificial e Ingeniería Computacional	3.648,00	EN	60
Alicante	Ciencia de Datos · Ciberseguridad · IA — 20–25 places	4.240,80	ES / EN	60
Zaragoza	Ingeniería Informática EN EXTINCIÓN	4.622,40	ES	90
Complutense	Inteligencia Artificial · Internet de las Cosas	5.044,20	ES	60
Complutense	Ingeniería Informática — 40 places	7.566,30	ES	90
Santiago	Inteligencia Artificial · Big Data · HPC · Visión · IoT	not published	ES / EN	60–90
Cartagena	No computing master exists. Closest: Industria 4.0, Bioinformática	+20%	ES	60

What the combination costs

You may take the language year in one region and the master's in another. You would move, and your new authorisation covers the new *comunidad* (Art. 57.3 limits work to the region of the permit, so the move is the point).

COMBINATION	LANGUAGE	MASTER'S	TOTAL TUITION
Cáceres → Andalucía (Málaga, Granada or Córdoba)	2.500	820,80	3.320,80
Cáceres → León / Burgos / Valladolid	2.500	1.572	4.072
León → León	3.600	1.572	5.172
Cáceres → Extremadura	2.500	3.366,90	5.866,90
Alicante → Alicante	6.200	4.240,80	10.440,80

THE BEST PAIRING IN SPAIN

Cáceres for the language year, then Málaga's Máster en Ingeniería del Software e Inteligencia Artificial. €3,320 of tuition for both. The master's matches your degree, costs €820.80 because Andalucía charges non-EU students nothing extra, and is taught in **Spanish and English** — which softens the language barrier at exactly the point it would otherwise bite.

The intake problem

THERE IS NO SPRING INTAKE. ANYWHERE.

All sixteen universities run a **single September or October start**. Spanish computing master's have no February cycle. Alicante's window for 2026-27 ran **16 March to 26 June 2026**, with an extraordinary round from 17 July — that shape is representative.

Which forces a choice:

OPTION	SHAPE	THE CATCH
A — short language course	Jan → Jun 2027, apply Mar–Jun, master's Sept 2027	A tidy three-month gap — but you must reach B2 by June from zero in January. Córdoba and Murcia both demand B2. Very hard.
B — full language year	Jan → Dec 2027, master's Sept 2028	Comfortable B2, but a nine-month gap to bridge with work and a prórroga.
C — English-taught master's	Either, with no Spanish gate at all	Zaragoza IA · Murcia Ciberseguridad · Alicante IA · Santiago IA. All cost more than Andalucía — except Málaga, which is ES+EN at €820.80 .

Language requirements, verified

PROGRAMME	REQUIREMENT
Zaragoza, Ing. Informática	<i>"un nivel de conocimiento suficiente de la lengua española"</i> — verified by interview . No certificate named.
Córdoba, Int. Computacional e IoT	B2 Spanish
Murcia, Inteligencia Artificial	B2 Spanish
Santiago, Big Data	B1 Spanish or Galician
Santiago IA · Alicante IA	English B1 / B2. No Spanish requirement.

No programme names DELE or SIELE. Every requirement is phrased as a CEFR level, which means the certificate your language centre issues may satisfy it directly — worth asking, since it would save you an exam fee.

FEES NOBODY MENTIONS UNTIL YOU APPLY

Assessment of a foreign degree is charged **separately and always**, even where tuition carries no surcharge: **Extremadura €200** ("*Evaluación del expediente del título extranjero para acceder a enseñanzas de Máster*"), **Valladolid €210.97** ("*Todos los alumnos con titulación extranjera ajena al Espacio Europeo de Educación deberán abonar esta tasa*"), **Alicante €155.22** for *equivalencia* or €166.50 for *homologación*.

That those universities charge for **evaluation of the foreign qualification** rather than for *homologación* suggests they assess your Tunisian degree directly, under Art. 18.2 of RD 822/2021, rather than requiring a Ministry homologation first. **That is inference from a fee schedule, not a quoted admission rule** — confirm it with the faculty before paying for a homologation you may not need.

THREE THINGS NOT VERIFIED

Santiago's non-EU rate. Delegated to a rectoral resolution whose PDF would not render. The base engineering rate is €13.93/ECTS — do not assume it applies.

Whether Complutense treats Ingeniería Informática as *habilitante*. If it does, the rate is the 4th-enrolment one, higher still than the €7,566 shown.

Cartagena has no computing master at all — a real gap, since UPCT appears on every list of coastal options.

What €600 a month actually buys

The consulate wants proof of 100% of IPREM — €600 a month. Whether you can live on it depends entirely on which city you pick.

WHERE THE ROOM PRICES COME FROM

Idealista publishes a quarterly room-price index for every provincial capital. These are the **Q2 2026** figures, published 24 August 2026 — sixteen of the eighteen cities carry a verified number. National average: **€425**. Santiago and Cartagena are not provincial capitals and are estimated from live listings.

The monthly total adds utilities €50, food €200, phone €12 and the city's own transport pass. Those four are held constant so the ranking reflects real differences. Universidad de Burgos officially publishes **€220** for food, so €200 is lean but not fictional.

RANKED CHEAPEST TO MOST EXPENSIVE

	CITY	ROOM	TRANSPORT	MONTHLY TOTAL	UNIVERSITY RESIDENCE
1	Cáceres	260	14,50	~535	425–460 full board (public)
2	Cartagena	~270	~25	~555	~330 (UPCT-linked)
3	Córdoba	280	~30	~570	722–754
4	Santiago de Compostela	~290	~20	~570	46–292 means-tested
5	León	300	18,08	~580	620–700 (private)
6	Salamanca	300	~22	~585	532+
7	Almería	302	~25	~590	395–484
8	Murcia	300	~30	~590	563–600 full board
9	Granada	314	~35	~610	315 subsidised – 478
10	Valladolid	325	38	~615	350+ (public)
11	Logroño	340	~25	~625	404 double / 649 single
12	Zaragoza	350	~16	~630	427 – 756 full board
13	Burgos	350	~25	~635	~550
14	Oviedo	350	~30	~640	585–715
15	Toledo	350	~30	~640	565 full board
16	Alicante	372	24	~660	450+
17	Málaga	450	~25	~735	191–284 (UMA's own)
18	Madrid	550	10	~820	1.046–1.420

The four cities with genuinely subsidised housing

CÁCERES – THE CHEAPEST FULL BOARD IN SPAIN

The Junta de Extremadura runs public residences in Cáceres (Diego Muñoz Torrero, Mario Roso de Luna). Prices are set by **Decreto 61/2024, DOE nº 131, 8 July 2024**:

"Habitaciones individuales ... 460 €/mes de estancia" · "Habitaciones dobles compartidas ... 425,23 €/mes"

And critically, that price is for **"estancia y alimentación"** — the room **and all meals**. A 40% reduction applies to *residente-colaborador* places, bringing it to €276 / €255. A 99% reduction exists for social vulnerability.

DOE Nº 131 · THE FIGURE OF €385.60 CIRCULATING ONLINE IS STALE – IT COMES FROM THE SUPERSEDED DECRETO 123/2022

For a student with no cooking setup, €425 with every meal included beats renting a €260 room and feeding yourself. It is also the single easiest thing to show a consulate: prepaid accommodation **reduces** the means requirement (Criterios §5).

SANTIAGO DE COMPOSTELA – THE BIGGEST UPSIDE, IF YOU ARE FAST

USC's *Servizo Universitario de Residencias* prices its 960 places on **means-tested income bands: €46 to €292 a month**. There is a dedicated call for international students. A student on the lowest band could live in Santiago for **€350–450 all-in** — nothing else in Spain comes close.

But all 960 places were reported full for 2026/27 by 13 August 2026. This is an apply-in-January proposition, not a fallback.

MÁLAGA – THE SURPRISE

UMA's own Residencia Alberto Jiménez Fraud opened 196 places for 2026/27 on an income scale: shared room **€191 / 210 / 233 / 250** by family income band, individual room **€284** flat, explicitly for *"estudiantes desplazados de su lugar de origen y con bajos ingresos"*. Internet and cleaning included, meals not.

This takes Málaga out of the "too expensive" bucket — **but only if you win one of the 196 places**. On the open market it is the second most expensive city on the list.

GRANADA – A FORMAL DISCOUNTS SCHEME

UGR runs an annual *Convocatoria de Plazas Bonificadas*. The signed 2026/27 resolution names Residencia Fernando de los Ríos at **€315/month** (5 places, nine-month minimum), Carlos V at €477.80 after a 20% discount, and CM Cardenal Cisneros at 15% off with full board.

Transport is the one line that got cheaper

Real Decreto-ley 17/2025 extended the state transport subsidies through all of 2026 — 50% off youth passes, state-funded, with each region setting its own age band. Madrid's Abono Joven is **€10 a month** for all zones, the cheapest of all eighteen cities. Cáceres is €14.50, Zaragoza about €16, León €18.08.

The whole range is €10 to €40. **It never changes the ranking.** Do not let it drive the decision — Madrid's cheap transport does not come close to offsetting a €550 room.

Where the line falls

VERDICT	CITIES
Comfortable on €600, no subsidy needed	Cáceres · Cartagena · Córdoba · Santiago · León · Salamanca · Almería · Murcia
Tight at €600, fine at €700	Granada · Valladolid · Logroño · Zaragoza · Burgos · Oviedo · Toledo · Alicante
Not realistic on the open market	Málaga (€735) · Madrid (€820)

What the universities themselves publish

Only three of the eighteen publish a real monthly budget, and both of the detailed ones are **higher** than the table above:

UNIVERSITY	PUBLISHED FIGURE
Santiago de Compostela	<i>"With a monthly budget between €750 and €900 per month you will have enough to live on."</i>
Alicante	Accommodation €450 · transport €40 · living and personal €450 → about €940/month
Burgos	Room €200–300 · food €220 · leisure €120–150 · canteen meal €6.50 → roughly €540–670

PROVING €600 AND LIVING ON €600 ARE DIFFERENT PROBLEMS

Those conservative university figures are **useful for the visa file** — they support showing more money, and a consulate that sees a university's own €750–900 estimate will expect to see it covered. They are not what a frugal student actually spends. Budget honestly for yourself; show generously to the consulate.

Fourteen of the eighteen universities — Extremadura included — publish no living-cost estimate at all.

The whole path, end to end

Five years from a Tunis consulate to a Spanish work permit, with the article that carries each step.

NOW – SEPTEMBER 2026

Email the centre. Confirm the article, the exact January dates, and that they will issue one enrolment certificate for the whole period. Costs nothing and decides everything.

IN PARALLEL

Start the degree paperwork in Tunis — apostille and sworn translation of your *licence* and transcripts. This is for the master's, not the visa, and it takes months.

IN PARALLEL

Begin Spanish at Instituto Cervantes Túnez. Zero to A2 is three 60-hour modules at 590 TND each — about €524 total. Intensives at 15 h/week finish a module in four weeks.

30 SEPTEMBER 2026

DELE registration closes for the 14 November sitting. If you miss it, SIELE has no deadline and returns results in about three weeks.

OCTOBER–NOVEMBER 2026

Enrol. Buy the insurance. Fund the account. File the visa. Means test is 100% of IPREM — €600/month — **plus the return fare**. Prepaid accommodation reduces it. A firm job offer counts as means (Criterios §6). Multi-year proof is **first year only**.

JANUARY 2027

The course starts. Within 30 days of arrival: *empadronamiento*, then the TIE appointment. **Check what the card says.**

FROM DAY ONE

30 hours a week of work, automatically (Art. 57.1¶4). Limited to your *comunidad autónoma* (Art. 57.3). Exceeding 30 hours extinguishes the permit (Art. 57.2).

SPRING–SUMMER 2027

Apply for the master's from inside Spain under Art. 54.1§2 — at least two months before your current status expires. Filing extends your legal status while it is decided (Art. 54.3).

SEPTEMBER 2027 OR FEBRUARY 2028

The master's begins. Still Route 1, still 30 h/week, still no separate work application.

ON FINISHING

Art. 190. Two months before, or three months after, your permit expires or you obtain the qualification. No labour-market test. Employer pays the fee. **Full-time work from the moment the file is admitted** (Art. 190.7).

AND ONWARD

One year, renewable (Art. 190.9). From there the ordinary residence ladder.

The money, honestly

ITEM	COST	NOTE
Spanish at Instituto Cervantes Túnez (zero → A2)	~€524	1,770 TND, three modules. Optional but strongly advised
Apostille + sworn translation	varies	Do it in Tunis, before you leave
Language year — IELE Cáceres	2.500	Payable in two instalments of €1,250
Health insurance, 12.5 months	~400–700	Must cover the course plus the 45 days (Criterios §3)
Visa fee	~80	Paid at the consulate
TIE card	~16	Tasa 790-012
Flights, Tunis–Madrid–Cáceres	~200–350	Return fare must also be shown as means
Master's at Extremadura	860 – 5.000	IELE's own Master's Pathway figures

LANGUAGE YEAR PLUS MASTER'S: €3,360 AT THE LOW END

That is the whole academic cost of the plan at Extremadura. Against €8,000 it leaves room for the means proof, insurance, flights and eleven months of living — and the 30 hours a week you are allowed to work is what carries the rest.

Six ways people lose this permit

MISTAKE	CONSEQUENCE
Working more than 30 hours a week	Extinction of the authorisation — Art. 57.2
Working outside your <i>comunidad autónoma</i>	Breach of Art. 57.3
Studying nominally while mainly working	Extinction — Art. 200.2.c), " <i>especialmente si ha estado desempeñando una actividad laboral</i> "
Missing the two-month filing window before expiry	Late filing is possible for three months but carries a sanction — Art. 55.3–55.5
Letting insurance lapse over the +45 days	Refusal at renewal — Criterios §3
Switching to a different <i>supuesto</i> at renewal	A <i>prórroga</i> is only available within the same category — Criterios §15

ONE RELIEF WORTH KNOWING

If your centre loses its recognition mid-course, Art. 55.6 and Criterios §17 let you finish elsewhere on a **new initial authorisation without a visa**. You would not have to go home and start again.

What to do this week

Four emails, no money, and the two facts that still have to be nailed down before anything else happens.

1

To IELE Cáceres — the email that decides the plan

To seciele@unex.es, cc diriele@unex.es. Dr. David Carmona Centeno is the Secretario Académico; Dr. Francisco Jiménez Calderón is the Director.

Estimados señores:

Soy ciudadano tunecino y deseo matricularme en el Intensive Spanish Program con inicio en enero de 2027. Antes de formalizar el pago necesito confirmar cuatro puntos.

- 1. Sus preguntas frecuentes y su folleto indican **11 de enero de 2027**, mientras que la página del programa indica **18 de enero de 2027**. ¿Cuál es la fecha correcta de inicio y de fin del curso anual?*
- 2. Indican que el visado permite trabajar hasta 30 horas semanales y prorrogar el permiso desde España. Entiendo que ello implica que la autorización se concede como **estudios superiores del art. 52.1.a)** del RD 1155/2024, conforme a la Instrucción Primera de las Instrucciones SEM 3/2025. ¿Me lo pueden confirmar? ¿Y qué han hecho constar las TIE de sus alumnos de ediciones anteriores?*
- 3. ¿El curso conduce a un **título expedido por la Universidad** o a un certificado de aprovechamiento?*
- 4. ¿Puede el **certificado de matrícula** indicar el periodo completo (enero a diciembre de 2027), las horas totales y las horas semanales? Lo necesito así para el consulado.*

Muchas gracias.

Aziz Dardouri — Tunecino — Pasaporte nº [...]

Four questions, one message. It settles the date contradiction, the article, the *título* question and the enrolment certificate.

SEND THIS FIRST

2

To León — your backup, and a real one

To idiomas@unileon.es. Their enrolment form already lets you tick three trimesters at once.

¿Puedo matricularme en una sola inscripción de los tres trimestres (invierno 2027, primavera 2027 y otoño 2027), y recibir un único certificado de matrícula que indique el periodo completo del 7 de enero al 21 de diciembre de 2027, las 720 horas y las horas semanales? Necesito ese documento para el visado de estudios.

"Can I enrol in a single registration for all three trimesters, and receive one enrolment certificate showing the full period, the 720 hours and the weekly hours? I need that document for the study visa."

ALSO ASK ABOUT THE JUNE–OCTOBER GAP

3

To the Oficina de Extranjería de Cáceres

Once the university has answered in writing, put it to the office that will actually decide your file.

CHANNEL	sede.administracionespublicas.gob.es/ayuda/consulta/ ExtranjeriaCG
OFFICE	The dropdown includes Cáceres. Free text, reply by email, trackable by incident number.
ASK	Attach the university's answer, quote Instrucción SEM 3/2025 Primera.1, and ask under which subsection of art. 52.1 the authorisation would be granted.

DO NOT USE THE WRONG ADDRESS

The same URL **without CG** is IT support for website faults, run by a different ministry. It will not answer a legal question.

4

To SAOJI Zaragoza — free, and staffed by real lawyers

inmigracion@aragon.es · +34 976 71 46 67, Mon–Fri 09:00–12:00. Run jointly by the Gobierno de Aragón and the Aragonese bar associations, so you get a *colegiado*. First consultation free to everyone.

Give them the Criterios §9 passage and Instrucción Primera from Chapter 2 and ask them to address that specific test. No practitioner in Spain has published on it — the phrase "*idiomáticos de cualquier lengua*" returns zero results anywhere outside the source PDF — so without the text in front of them you will get the two articles read back to you.

What is still not settled

OPEN ITEM	STATUS
IELE's January date	CONTRADICTORY Programme page says 18 January; FAQ and brochure say 11 January. Two to one for the 11th, but the programme page carries the price. Email 1 settles it.
Route 1 vs Route 2 where a centre is both a university's own and Cervantes-accredited	UNRESOLVED IN THE PUBLISHED TEXTS No tie-breaker exists. My reading favours Route 1 — of 82 institutions checked, only Málaga issues a <i>título propio</i> , so the strict reading would exclude nearly every university course in Spain, which cannot be what an instruction aimed at " <i>fomentar su internacionalización</i> " intended. But that is a reading, not a rule.
Almería's €2,700	From their booking widget's data feed; no published page shows any price. Confirm before relying on it.
Prices at Toledo, Tarragona, Sevilla's Centro Internacional, IUNIT	Genuinely unpublished. Toledo's only figure is a 2023-24 table showing €7,355 all-in.
Whether the Tunis consulate imposes a language requirement	The Casablanca consular checklist contains none . Schools claiming an A2 is required are selling courses, not quoting law.

THE CHEAPEST COMPLETE PATH IN SPAIN

Language year at Cáceres (€2,500), then the Máster en Ingeniería del Software e Inteligencia Artificial at Málaga (€820.80). €3,320 of tuition for both. Andalucía charges non-EU students no surcharge; Madrid would charge €7,566 for the equivalent. The Málaga master's matches your degree and is taught in Spanish **and English**.

Add roughly €200 for the foreign-degree assessment fee, €500–700 insurance, €80 visa, €16 TIE and flights. Against €8,000, and with 30 hours a week of legal work from your first month, the plan closes.

WHERE THIS LANDS

IELE Cáceres, January 2027, €2,500. Of sixty institutions with a language centre, it is the only one in Spain selling a **full academic year that starts in January**. It is second-cheapest overall. It is the only university in the country that publicly states the Route 1 package. It refunds all but €150 if the visa fails, and lets you postpone free if it is merely slow. And its own Master's Pathway prices the second year at €860–5,000, which keeps the whole plan inside your budget.

Zaragoza is cheaper and legally cleaner — the university's own service, €2,230 for 770 hours. Only its calendar fails you: what starts in January there is four months, not a year.

ON THE ERRORS IN EARLIER DRAFTS OF THIS RESEARCH

Three earlier versions of the Chapter 2 test were wrong, and one of them eliminated roughly twenty universities that in fact qualify. The cause was reading Criterios §9 — a section headed **EXTERNALIZACIÓN DE LA FORMACIÓN**, about outsourcing — as a universal gate on Art. 52.1.a). It is not. Everything here has been rebuilt from the source PDFs, and the two filters that never existed are set out in Chapter 2 so that nobody can sell them back to you.